VARUN NS

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Product Management | Market Intelligence, Vendor Evaluation & Agreements | SaaS, IoT & AI Product Lifecycle

PROFILE

Product professional with **4 years** in large matrixed organisations, combining a **B.E. in Information Science** with an **MBA from IMT Ghaziabad**. At Sodexo India, I lead technology initiatives through customer evaluation and market requirements, assess emerging technologies, develop cost/ROI business cases, define product requirements and acceptance criteria, and coordinate product delivery from concept through rollout. Experienced in AI, IoT, SaaS and enterprise technology solutions, with a track record of evaluating 60+ vendors, contributing to product roadmaps and delivering measurable business outcomes. Previously at Genpact, drove finance technology transformation and automation initiatives delivering $35M+ in client value.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Innovation Lead (AI & Product Management) — Nov 2025 – Present

Sodexo India — *Bengaluru*

Product development and delivery

- **Responsible for four technology products (RFP Response Agent, Menu AI, Sodexo My Apps, and HR Agent)** coordinating with Technology, Business, Global teams, Operations, SaaS partners, Bid teams, and End users across product definition, cost and impact assessment, development, and rollout.
    1. (**RFP Response Agent** - Cut average RFP drafting time from **15 to 10 days (33% faster)** for the bid team
    2. **Menu AI:** Reduced menu-planning errors by **20%** and saved the culinary team **~20% of planning time** each month.
- **Internal platforms:** Worked with existing SaaS vendors to develop Sodexo's internal HR application, owning requirements, delivery and rollout. Used by close to 1 lakh employees.
- **Customer Requirements & Product Validation**: Engaged client stakeholders and end users to understand business requirements, validate solution fit, translate needs into product specifications and acceptance criteria, and incorporate feedback into implementation and rollout decisions.
- **Product Delivery & Validation**: Defined product requirements, specifications and acceptance criteria; coordinated UAT, resolved gaps and ensured delivery against agreed scope and timelines.

Strategy and business cases

- **Technology Strategy & Roadmap:** Worked with the India CIO to develop the technology strategy, define key priorities, and establish implementation timelines; prepared and presented the roadmap to the Managing Director and Sodexo India leadership team.
- **Technology Project Planning & Business Cases**: Developed business cases for 10+ technology initiatives aligned with the India technology roadmap, evaluating costs, implementation timelines, expected ROI, and business impact to support deployment planning and leadership decisions.

Market intelligence, vendor evaluation and agreements

- **Competitive & Market Intelligence**: **Single POC for technology vendor evaluation and deployments -** Benchmarked 60+ vendors and emerging technology solutions across 10+ categories, comparing product capabilities, technology maturity, commercial models and scalability to identify suitable solutions and inform product roadmap priorities.
- Built a **market-intelligence agent** (6 signal categories) to track technology trends; findings added **4 initiatives** to the roadmap.
- **Led vendor negotiations**: **15+ agreements** worth **₹10cr +**, issued vendor-neutral RFPs and onboarded vendors through PO and IT clearance.

AI and technology leadership

- **India AI Champion (nominated by the Global team):** Led AI adoption across Sodexo India's business functions and client operations, driving the implementation of 5 AI use cases and delivering AI capability-building programmes for 200+ employees across Finance and Growth teams.
- **Led Sodexo's AI Leadership Programme at IIT Bombay**: Evaluated 15+ domestic and international academic institutions, shortlisted IIT Bombay, and co-designed the AI Leadership Programme curriculum with faculty, delivering the programme to 15 senior executives, including Sodexo's CEO, CFO, CMO, and CHRO.

Assistant Manager, Lean Digital Transformation — Jun 2023 – Nov 2025

Genpact — *Jaipur*

- **Led finance-operations technology transformation for 4 global clients**, generating **$35M+** via root-cause resolution of inconsistent processes, Direct Debit and GRNI balances
- **Youngest global agentic AI demo lead:** Represented and demoed **4 agentic AI products** (**~$2M** each) to CFOs and finance directors at **Fortune 500** firms, alongside sales
- **Invoice auto-posting:** analysed exceptions, wrote the BRD and redesigned system rules, lifting auto-posting **35% → 50%** and **15% → 25%** (**$150k**); also shipped duplicate payment detection and SAP payment-proposal automation worth **$100k+**
- **Enhanced Helpdesk Accuracy** from **85% to 98%** by creating and executing a 30-60-90 day improvement plan, eliminating inefficiencies and optimizing support processes.
- **Power BI Transformation Tracker:** built Transformation leadership's single source of truth for project KPIs across **40+ clients**
- **Automation & AI Initiatives:** Led automation initiatives across 4 client accounts, including internal AI product development, process automation using Excel macros, and reporting automation through Power BI to improve operational efficiency and reduce manual effort.

Tools: *SAP, Power BI, VBA, Excel, Lean (VSM, PSR, FMEA)*

Summer Intern, International Business (Market Research) — Apr 2022 – Jun 2022

Care Health Insurance — *Gurgaon*

- Assessed marketability across **5 Middle East markets**; helped the International Business Head narrow expansion to **2 countries**

Business Development Associate — Mar 2019 – Jun 2019

Byju's — *Bengaluru*

- Onboarded **22 customers** and generated **₹15L+** through live product demos; ranked **top 2** in the team

PROJECTS

- **Jaipur AI Travel Planner:** built an agentic travel platform covering ticket booking, itinerary planning and event discovery for Jaipur; (live on varunns.vercel.app)
- **Myntra - Wishlist Conversion (Next Leap PM Fellowship awarded Top Fellow Status):** Fashion shoppers delay Wishlist buys over fit doubt and lose their size to stockouts → defined and prototyped an AI agent that resolves fit using clothes they already own, validated across 1,505 user signals, 47 surveys and 7 interviews (6/7 had lost an item while delaying). (live on varunns.vercel.app)
- **FlowSphere:** built a full-stack AI tool for market analysis, portfolio management and stock screening (live on varunns.vercel.app)

SKILLS

- **Product:** Product lifecycle, roadmapping, business cases (time to market, cost, ROI), market analysis, specifications, KPIs, UAT
- **Commercial:** Vendor negotiation, third-party agreements, TCO and cost modelling, RFPs, vendor evaluation
- **Technical:** IoT sensors and BMS / HVAC systems, Claude, Antigravity, Gemini, Zapier, SAP, Power BI, Vibe Coding

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **B.E., Information Science**, SJB Institute of Technology, Bengaluru, 2018
- **MBA (PGDM),** IMT Ghaziabad, 2023 | **CAT 97.77** percentile
- **Next Leap – Product Management** - Top Fellow (2026)
- **McKinsey Forward Program** (2025)
- **Strategy Execution, Harvard Business School Online** (2023)